

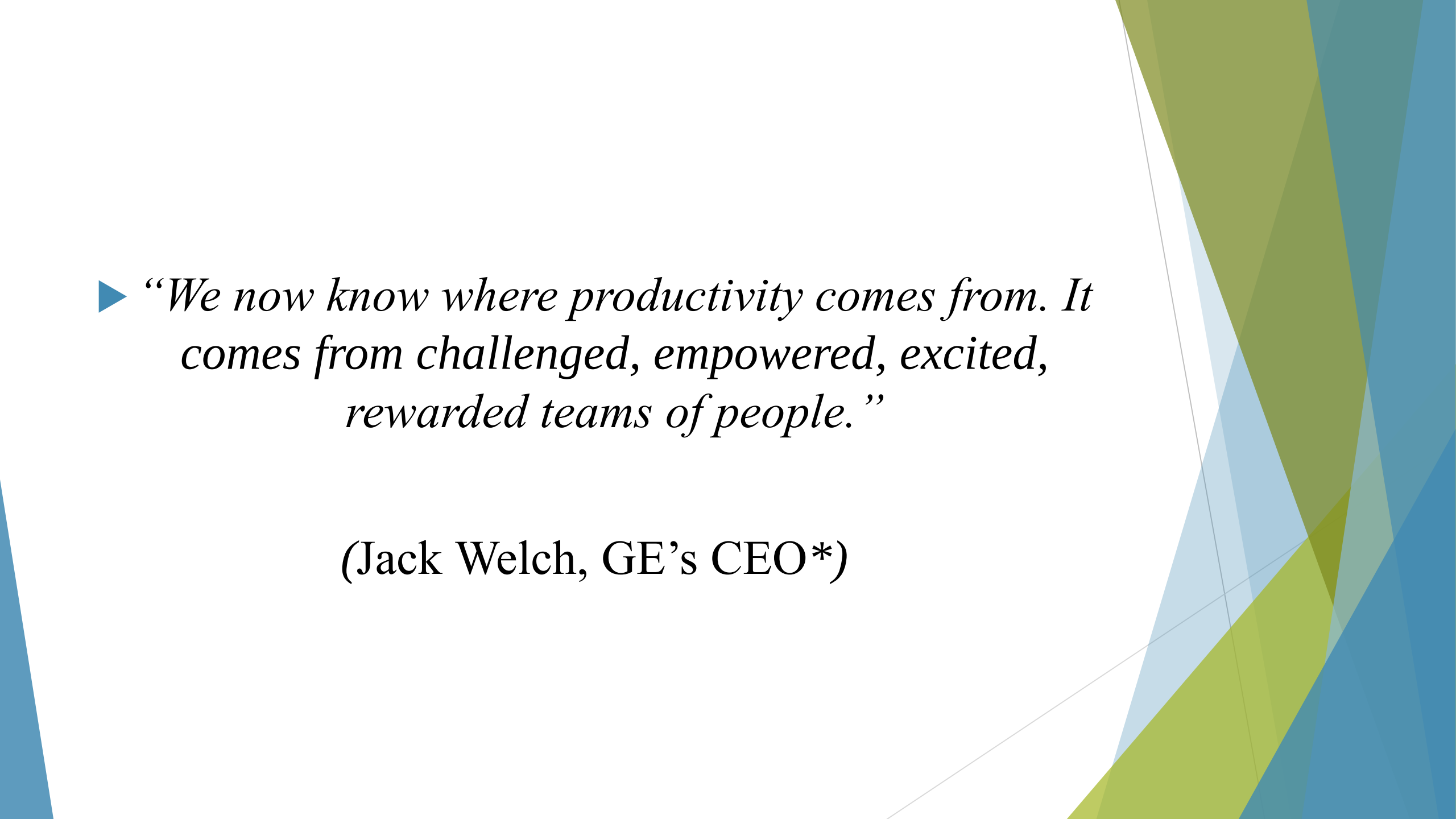
Understanding Work Teams

Chapter - 6



Learning Objectives

- 1) Teams - Definitions
- 2) Difference between groups and teams
- 3) Types of teams
- 4) Creating Effective Teams (Team Effectiveness Model)

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- ▶ *“We now know where productivity comes from. It comes from challenged, empowered, excited, rewarded teams of people.”*

(Jack Welch, GE's CEO*)

Google Offers Voluntary Exit Packages To Employees Not 'Embracing' AI

Google has offered voluntary exit packages to employees in specific business teams, encouraging alignment with AI mission and higher work intensity.

Edited by: [Abhinav Singh](#) | [World News](#) | Feb 12, 2026 09:17 am IST ⓘ

Read Time: 3 mins

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Google's business unit is offering voluntary exit packages to some employees.

Salesforce Lays Off Nearly 1,000 Employees in Early 2026 Cuts



By Sasha Semjonova

February 10, 2026

Salesforce has laid off employees earlier this month, with these cuts affecting around 1,000 roles, according to Business Insider.

The affected employees allegedly fall into Salesforce's marketing, product management, and data analytics departments, as well as the Agentforce AI team and Heroku team.

The cover of 'The Salesforce Data Quality Playbook' features a dark background with glowing blue and orange data points and lines.

Where is your **Salesforce data** holding you back in 2026?

Get the data quality playbook

The cloudingo logo consists of the word 'cloudingo' in a white, lowercase, sans-serif font, with a stylized white cloud icon above the 'i'.

[Download Now](#)

The Scope of Layoffs

According to an [insider source](#), under 1,000 roles were affected in this particular layoff round, and it has not targeted one team specifically, instead impacting four core teams, including the Agentforce team.

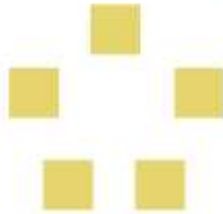
*“A team is a group of people who are
interdependent with respect to
information, resources, knowledge, and
skills and who seek to combine their
efforts to achieve a common goal”*

Group v/s Teams

Exhibit 10-1

Comparing Work Groups and Work Teams

Work Groups



Share information
Neutral (sometimes negative)
Individual
Random and varied

Work Teams



Collective performance
Positive
Individual and mutual
Complementary

Goal

Synergy

Accountability

Skills

Types of Teams

▶ 1. **Problem-Solving Teams**

- Traditionally, teams were typically composed of 5 to 12 employees from the same department who met for a few hours each week to discuss ways of improving quality, efficiency, and the work environment
- These **problem-solving teams** rarely have the authority to unilaterally implement any of their suggestions.
- They provide suggestions and Recommendations

Types of Teams

▶ 2. **Self-Managed Work Teams**

- Groups of employees (typically 10 to 15 in number) who perform highly related or interdependent jobs and take on many of the responsibilities of their former supervisor
- Tasks such as planning and scheduling work, assigning tasks to members, making operating decisions, taking action on problems, and working with suppliers and customers are usually taken by self-managed teams
- Fully self-managed work teams even select their own members and evaluate each other's performance.
- Supervisory positions take on decreased importance and are sometimes even eliminated

Types of Teams

▶ 3. **Cross-Functional Teams**

- Employees from different functional areas but same hierarchical level come together to perform a task.
- Today cross-functional teams are so widely used it is hard to imagine a major organizational undertaking without one.
- All the major automobile manufacturers—Toyota, Honda, Nissan, BMW, GM, Ford, and Chrysler—currently use this form of team to coordinate complex projects.

Types of Teams

▶ 4. **Virtual Teams**

- **Virtual teams** use computer technology to unite physically dispersed members and achieve a common goal.
- They collaborate online—using communication links such as wide-area networks, videoconferencing, or e-mail—whether they're a room away or continents apart
- Virtual teams are all pervasive these days

Types of Teams

► 5. Multi-teams systems

- **Multiteam systems (MTSs)** are networks of interrelated teams united by common purposes.
- In other words **MTSs** are teams of collaborating teams working together to achieve shared goals.

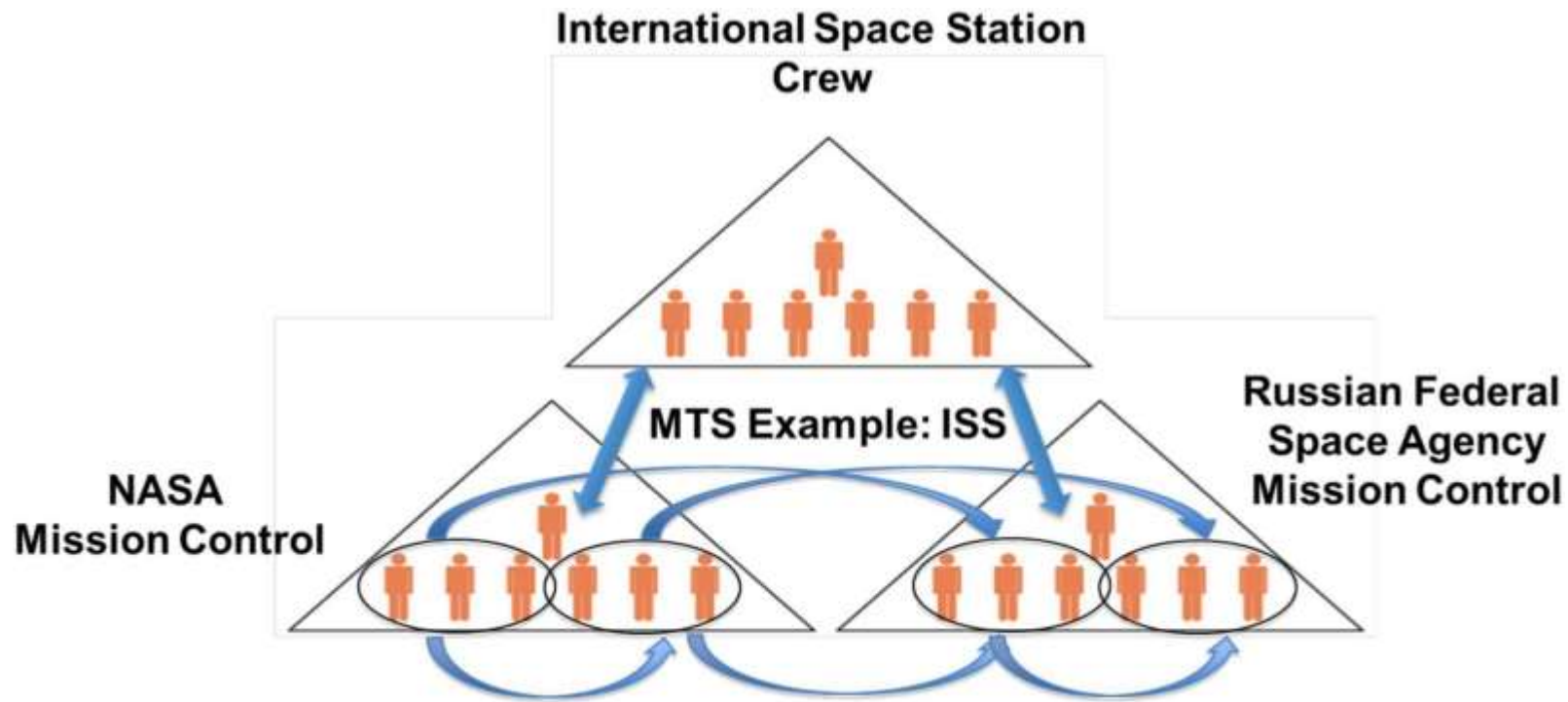
Types of Teams

► 5. **Multi-teams systems**

- MTSs are highly visible in the public sector in the form of action teams such as emergency response teams.
- For instance, a hypothetical MTS could consist of 5 teams: police, firefighters, emergency medical technicians (EMTs), an emergency room team of surgeons, and a recovery team

Types of Teams

Multi-teams systems



Creating Effective Teams



Team Effectiveness

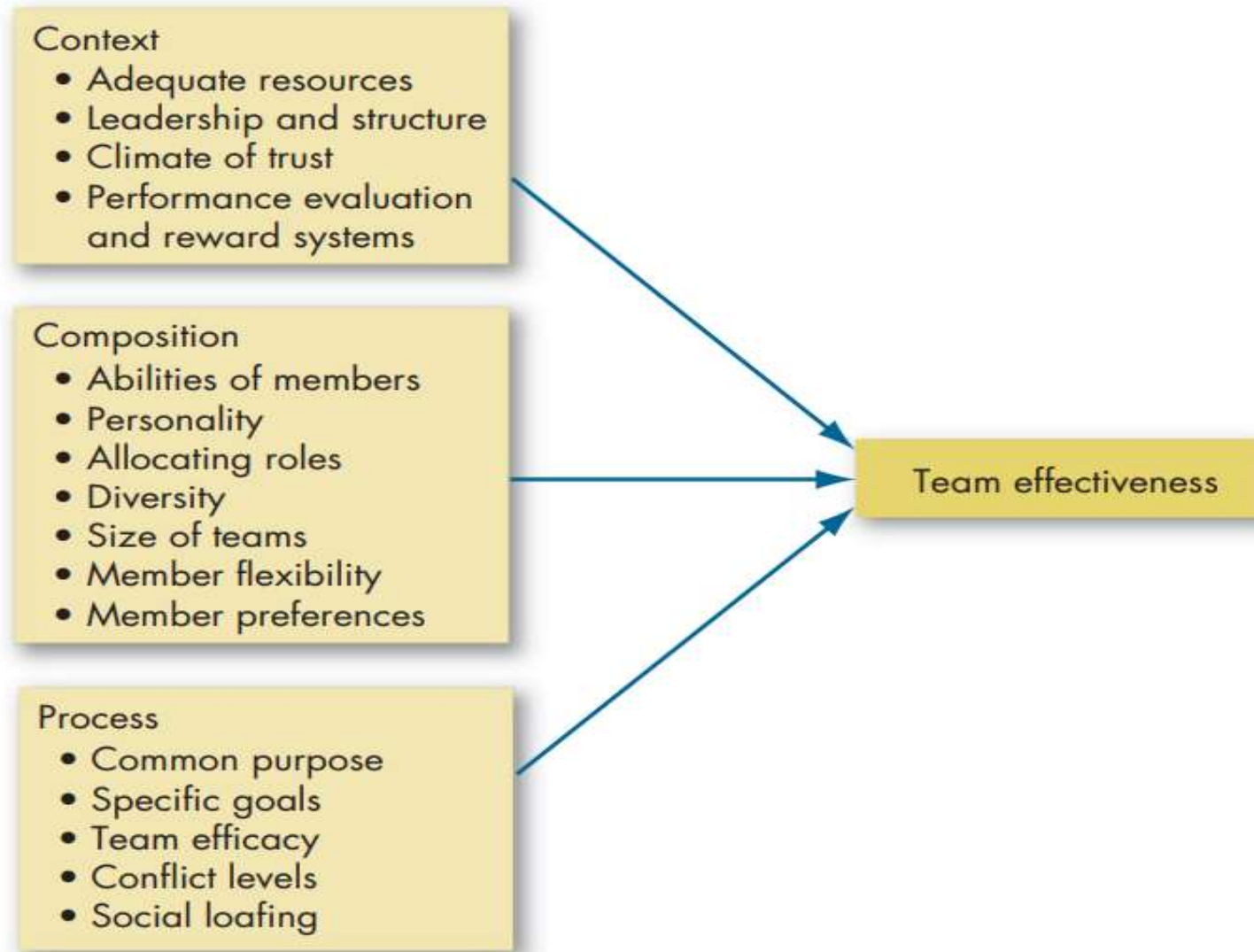
- ▶ Team effectiveness is the **capacity** of a group of people, usually with complementary skills, **to work together to accomplish goals set out by an authority, team members, or team leaders.**
- ▶ Highly effective teams are able to motivate each other and collaborate to solve problems, which leads to greater results.

Team Effectiveness

- ▶ Key components of effective teams are :
- ▶ 1) Context
- ▶ 2) Composition
- ▶ 3) Processes

Exhibit 10-3

Team Effectiveness Model



Team Effectiveness

- ▶ 1) **Context** - context include
 - ▶ A) **Adequate Resources** - Resources that a team receives from Organization
 - ▶ B) **Leadership and Structure** - Who decides what to do? What will be the team structure? Will there be shared leadership? Will it be a self-managed team?
 - ▶ C) **Climate of Trust** - Members of effective team trust each other and also exhibit trust for their leaders
 - ▶ D) **Performance Evaluation and Reward Systems** - How to get team members individually and jointly accountable . E..g. Google lay off Recruitment teams

Google lays off hundreds of employees in global recruiting team: Report

Google is laying off hundreds of employees from its recruiting team globally, as the new hiring has slowed down at the Alphabet company, the media reported.

Microsoft

Microsoft has laid off entire teams behind Virtual, Mixed Reality, and HoloLens

By [Jez Corden](#) last updated January 23, 2023

HoloLens, Virtual Reality, and Mixed Reality are all but dead at Microsoft.

Team Effectiveness

- ▶ 2) **Team Composition** - The composition of team affects effectiveness as it includes
 - A) **Abilities of Members** - KSAs of team members
 - B) **Personality of Members** - How open, supportive and level of conscientiousness team members have. A highly disagreeable member is always problematic
 - C) **Allocation of Roles** - How effectively roles are allocated in the team based on the skills and abilities of the team members
 - D) **Diversity** - Is needed for diverse views, for a complete picture
 - E) **Size of Teams** Most experts agree, keeping teams small is a key to improving group effectiveness
 - F) **Member Preferences:** Not every employee is a team player. If members are chosen against the will effectiveness will be low

Working in
Feature or
Pizza Teams



“

If you can't feed a team
with two pizzas, it's too
large.

- Jeff Bezos, CEO, Amazon

Size of the team
5-6 / 6-8

Team Processes

- ▶ 3) Team Processes
- ▶ Team processes are related to :
 - ▶ member commitment to a common purpose
 - ▶ establishment of specific team goals
 - ▶ team efficacy: belief in the team's abilities
 - ▶ a managed level of conflict
 - ▶ minimized social loafing

These will be especially important in larger teams and in teams that are highly interdependent.